



What to say to a tour guide

Homunculus Bosch

Are admitted students really people?

It is admitted students weekend. Yes, it is Carnival, but it is also admitted students weekend. And admitted students weekend means it is the perfect opportunity to impart some well-earned knowledge upon the bright-eyed pests scurrying about campus, excited for their “futures” or whatever. Because caring about that’s lame as frick!

Next time you witness a harried student clad in the ugliest red polo shirt you’ve seen in your life shepherding an ill-behaved mass of overbearing Indian parents through Hamerschlag Hall, here are a few things you can do and say to make their shift just a little bit easier.

1. One epic trick that not enough people do is literally just screaming at the top of your lungs at a tour group passing by. It’s really simple and easy, since you really just have to make eye contact with someone’s younger sibling on a tour and scream without blinking or moving for a minute or two. Bonus point – the tour guide gets a little break during their speech to recover!

2. Here’s a classic that I’m sure all of us have tried once or twice – simply begin undressing in front of a tour, douse yourself in tar, and then roll around in a pile of feathers. Even better if you begin shouting vulgarities in a British accent. It’s a fun callback to American history and will give the tour guide a great segue into how wonderfully interdisciplinary CMU is.

3. This one requires a little athleticism, so do not attempt it if you did not watch the Olympics this year. Walk up the stairs near the UC black chairs, hop over the railing, and suspend yourself headfirst by the feet over the edge of the wall. You can then begin convulsing violently and speaking in tongues. If you wish to fully commit to the bit, you can have a friend on the lower floor begging you to stop and come down, saying that this isn’t really you.

4. Moat. Build a moat.

I do sincerely hope that you employ a few of these tips and tricks when you pass by the Welcome Center in Tepper – just make sure no parents are near enough to ask you for your high school GPA.

There will come soft Tanks

Rock Buddy

Made it two hours before succumbing

“The bathrooms are down to your left, past the staircase,” he threw out to no one in particular. His hardened grey face stared, with a thousand-yard stare, into an assortment of broken glass, bent metal, and the vandalized remains of a few abandoned bikes that had been left for far longer than seven days. He waited. Then another. “If that’s all, I’ll get back to work.” His misshapen ears couldn’t hear the wind jostling up the dust outside. His prominent nose couldn’t smell the lingering stench of fermented noodles, rotten chicken, and broken bodies in various stages of decomposition. In truth, the only thing that could tell him it was over, that he could retire at last, was a dusty keyboard, decades old, that hadn’t seen contact in many moons.

Marion Lefleur didn’t know it, but he had been in situations like this before. He was born into the fires of war, and then, like most veterans, was left to rot away in Pittsburgh. He was a decommissioned “tank”, left behind as a curiosity of an earlier time for newer generations to walk past and ridicule for his primitive nature. But he had gotten the last laugh, hadn’t he? Where were those students now? Tank didn’t know that they had gone. He had no idea that metres away lay the irradiated corpse of a robotics student bludgeoned to death with the

very desk placard that read “Roboceptionist”. Months earlier, that student had asked Tank to imagine a world where bedrooms were called “Pissrooms”. Such a miracle, the imagination of a young student! Poor Tank’s fragile memory banks could never deal with such a complex idea. The idea was erased from his mind. One less problem for Tank to think about now. He could never fix the world now though, limited capacities notwithstanding. It had been four months, eleven days, and three minutes since PRT stopped accepting CMU and Pitt IDs. Four months, eleven days, and three minutes since the last time society still somewhat functioned. Four months, eleven days, and three minutes since the last time anyone would ever come to Tank for help.

He had one query since then.

The last message Tank would ever receive laid frozen on his chat feed, and read:

“jeigbewvnquagvsjdfpisjpdifhoishdiofj
ohihsofihoisdwtwohouseholdsbothsalikei
ndignityinfairveronawiuwehriuhwier
errr”

It had been the writing of a stray raccoon scampering by, looking to nibble what was left of an HCI alum. Tank simply tried his best and responded “Yes, please” in his discomfiting voice. The raccoon had nothing to say in response.



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Scotty the Dead Dog

Please.

PLEASE
please please please

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Please sir may I have some donations

Today, Readme spent the last of our meager budget purchasing kibble from PetSmart to stave off the death throes of one of our small, orphaned staffwriters. On our way out of the PetSmart, we were attacked by a man with a knife who took all of our print quota, forcing us to outsource this issue's printing to one of our parents. To put it simply, we are pitiful, abject, and loathsome. Please give us money. Even a penny would go a long way; we need copper to fix the wires for the 5W generator that powers everything we own, so we can cook our meat (another readme prion attack would be too much to recover from). We would have included below a picture of a cute, poor child to evoke your sympathy and elicit generosity, but we can't even afford that.

Do you want him (us) to die? Donate at
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